



Visa & Work Permits

How to Extend or Change Your Visa in China



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How to Extend or Change Your Visa in China

If you need to stay longer or change your visa type while in China, here's what you need to know.

Visa Extension:

Apply at the local Public Security Bureau (Exit-Entry Administration) at least 7 days before your visa expires. Required documents:

- * Valid passport with current visa
- * Registration form of temporary residence
- * Passport-sized photos (48x33mm, white background)
- * Supporting documents (invitation letter, hotel booking, etc.)
- * Application fee: ¥160 (single entry), varies by type



Visa Type Change:

Changing visa type (e.g., L to Z) typically requires leaving China and re-entering with the new visa. However, some changes can be made within China:

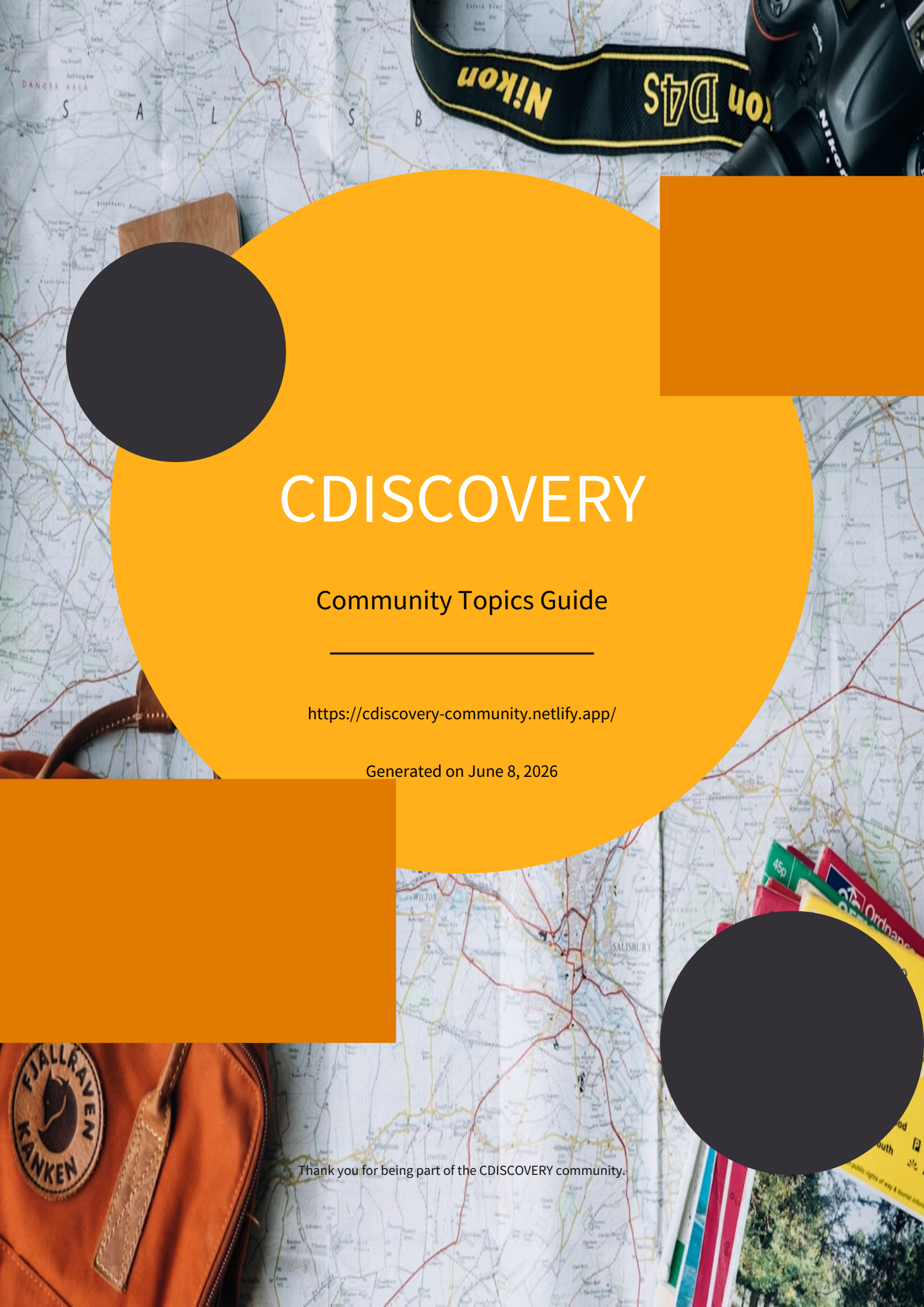
- * Tourist (L) to Student (X): Possible with university enrollment documents
- * Tourist (L) to Work (Z): Usually requires exit and re-entry
- * Student (X) to Work (Z): Possible with job offer and Work Permit

Overstay Penalties:

- * Fine: ¥500-1,000 per day of overstay
- * Potential detention and deportation
- * Entry ban: 1-10 years depending on severity
- * Always apply for extension before your visa expires!



[Ministry of Foreign Affairs](https://www.mfa.gov.cn)



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